RESILIENCE ENTREPRENEURSHIP INNOVATION & NATURE

REIN Ghana Hub × Academic City: what ACity brings and what it costs

Internal prep for Gideon Blaauw (CleantechHUB) with Laurence Kalinsky (PVBLIC), before the meeting with Pav, Academic City University (ACity), Accra. 20 October 2026.

1. What ACity brings, in kind

TEC (Technology & Entrepreneurship Center), led by Makafui Awuku, runs the US State Department CCE Climate Tech Accelerator.

In Q3 2025, TEC trained 140 youth in 73 workshops. Participation was 48% female.

Africa's first Sustainability Laboratory was inaugurated on 9 February 2023. It is a CCE initiative, and home of the Telesto Climate Tech Accelerator (17 entrepreneurs in the 2023 cohort).

About 500 students, and 25+ nationalities. AI and Robotics degrees fit PVBLIC ALI (AI Leapfrog Initiative) Logic Centers. International industry mentors 200+ students and educators a year. Northeastern University is a research link. Alumni are at Apple UK and Zipline.

The US State Department CCE stays the anchor. REIN adds a non-US capital channel: FOSD (Family Offices for Sustainable Development) family offices and European corporates. That channel points toward the ACU Foundation's US$10 million goal over three years.

REIN stage	Scale	ACity asset
Ideation	50 participants, 4 weeks	TEC workshops and students
Incubation	25 teams, 10 weeks	Sustainability Lab and Telesto
Acceleration	10 teams, 12 weeks	CCE Climate Tech Accelerator
Growth	4 teams, 12 weeks, investor connections	FOSD and PVBLIC / UNGA
Hub operations		Campus, TEC staff

2. Cost Structure

These assets reduce cost and risk. They do not replace cash.

External cash follows a three-year sliding scale. Year 1 is the full funnel, plus setup and integration.

Year	External cash	Level, Year 1 = full bar
Year 1	**US$103,000**	
Year 2	**US$75,000**	
Year 3	**US$50,000**	
3-year total	**US$228,000**	**Sum of the three years**

Year 1 split: programs US$75,000, comms and hub maintenance US$8,000, and operations and integration US$20,000.

External need falls about 50% by Year 3, as ACity takes on delivery and local sponsors come in.

3. Timeline

Gideon has confirmed the Q1 2027 launch: January 2027 is the design month, February 2027 is on-site training, and March 2027 is the start of Incubation. Ideation (4 weeks) sits inside February with that training, so it still comes before Incubation. That February placement is an assumption. Acceleration (12 weeks) and Growth (12 weeks) follow in sequence.

Jan 2027 Design month	**Feb 2027** On-site training Ideation, 4 weeks **Assumption**	**Mar 2027** Incubation starts 10 weeks	**Then** Acceleration 12 weeks	**Then** Growth 12 weeks
21 Oct 2026 Meeting with Pav	**1 Dec 2026** Agreement and Year 1 funding **TO CONFIRM**	**Sept 2027** UNGA82 and Climate Week NYC **Team slots TO CONFIRM**	**2028** Year 2 US$75,000 **TO CONFIRM**	**2029** Year 3 US$50,000 **TO CONFIRM**

UNGA82 opens 7 September 2027. The general debate opens 21 September 2027 (UN schedule). Climate Week NYC is the same month. Exact Climate Week dates are TO CONFIRM. The REIN plan is an SDG Media Zone slot for 2 incubation winners and 2 growth teams. That slot is TO CONFIRM.

4. Donor programs in Ghana, 2026-2030

Donor / program	Period	Size	Fit for REIN
Danida Green Business Partnerships (1)	3 to 5 years. 2025 round closed.	DKK 4 million to 15 million	Climate adaptation. Ghana eligible. A university cannot administer.
GIZ / BMZ, GCIC at Ashesi (2)	PFS ends Dec 2025. Renewal UNVERIFIED.	About EUR 1.2 million	Closest university climate incubator.
AfDB MicroGREEN (3)	From Mar 2024. End past 2026 UNVERIFIED.	US$850,000 plus initial US$1 million	Green jobs. Already with Invest in Africa.
Mastercard Climate Impact Challenge (4)	3-year grants. Round 2 to Jan 2026.	US$250,000 to US$1,500,000	For cohort startups, not the hub host.
EU Global Gateway, green growth for jobs (5)	MIP to 2027. 2025-27 amount not set.	EUR 71.05 million was 2021-24. Later years UNVERIFIED.	Strategic window. No named hub call.
UK-Ghana Growth Partnership (6)	2026 to 2028	GBP 5 million green prep. GBP 6 million AI and science.	Live partnership. Not a hub grant.

Ranks 7 to 10 are in the full scan. (1) danida-business-partnerships.dk (2) ghanacic.ashesi.edu.gh (3) afdb.org MicroGREEN release (4) frp.org Climate Impact Challenge Fund (5) EU MIP annex, international-partnerships.ec.europa.eu (6) gov.uk UK-Ghana Growth Partnership.

Best routes: Danida with PVBLIC as lead, GIZ renewal, Mastercard for cohort startups. USAID out (86% of awards terminated, Mar 2025).